

Bank 3 — Important MCQs, Topic-wise (with answers)

Paper: NPSC CTSE — General English & GK (Combined).

What this is: 160 important MCQs sorted by syllabus section. It avoids repeating questions already in Bank 1 (most repeated) and Bank 2 (expected 2026). The answer is printed directly under each question.

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§1 — INDIAN POLITY

1. Untouchability is abolished under:

(a) Art. 14 (b) Art. 15 (c) Art. 17 (d) Art. 18

Ans: (c) Article 17.

2. Fundamental Rights are contained in:

(a) Part II (b) Part III (c) Part IV (d) Part IVA

Ans: (b) Part III (Arts. 12-35). Part IV = DPSP; Part IVA = Fundamental Duties.

3. Under Art. 79, Parliament of India consists of:

(a) Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha (b) President, Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha (c) PM and both Houses (d) Lok Sabha only

Ans: (b) The President is a part of Parliament.

4. A joint sitting of both Houses (Art. 108) is presided over by:

(a) President (b) Vice-President (c) Speaker of Lok Sabha (d) Prime Minister

Ans: (c) Speaker of the Lok Sabha.

5. The President's power to grant pardon is under:

(a) Art. 72 (b) Art. 123 (c) Art. 143 (d) Art. 161

Ans: (a) Article 72. (A Governor's is Art. 161; ordinances are Art. 123.)

6. The Election Commission of India is provided for under:

(a) Art. 280 (b) Art. 315 (c) Art. 324 (d) Art. 356

Ans: (c) Article 324. (UPSC = Art. 315.)

7. The oath of office to the President of India is administered by:
(a) Vice-President (b) Chief Justice of India (c) Speaker (d) Prime Minister

Ans: (b) Chief Justice of India.

8. The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to:
(a) President (b) Rajya Sabha (c) Lok Sabha (d) Parliament as a whole

Ans: (c) Lok Sabha (Art. 75(3)).

9. The maximum strength of the Rajya Sabha is:
(a) 238 (b) 245 (c) 250 (d) 552

Ans: (c) 250 (238 elected + 12 nominated by the President).

10. How many languages are in the Eighth Schedule?
(a) 14 (b) 18 (c) 22 (d) 24

Ans: (c) 22.

11. The idea of a Concurrent List was borrowed from:
(a) USA (b) Canada (c) Australia (d) Ireland

Ans: (c) Australia. (Single citizenship → UK; Fundamental Rights → USA; Emergency → Germany/Weimar; Fundamental Duties → USSR.)

12. The writ "Habeas Corpus" literally means:
(a) We command (b) To have the body (c) By what authority (d) To be certified

Ans: (b) "To have the body". (Mandamus = we command; Quo Warranto = by what authority; Certiorari = to be certified.)

13. The 74th Amendment (1992) deals with:
(a) Panchayats (b) Municipalities (c) Cooperative societies (d) Anti-defection

Ans: (b) Municipalities (12th Schedule). The 73rd = Panchayats (11th Schedule).

14. The Governor of a state is appointed by:
(a) Chief Minister (b) Prime Minister (c) President (d) Chief Justice

Ans: (c) The President (Art. 155).

15. The first Speaker of the Lok Sabha was:
(a) M. A. Ayyangar (b) G. V. Mavalankar (c) Hukam Singh (d) N. Sanjiva Reddy

Ans: (b) G. V. Mavalankar.

16. The first Chief Election Commissioner of India was:
(a) T. N. Seshan (b) Sukumar Sen (c) K. V. K. Sundaram (d) S. P. Sen Verma

Ans: (b) Sukumar Sen.

17. The 106th Amendment (2023, "Nari Shakti Vandan") provides:
(a) 50% reservation in Panchayats (b) one-third reservation for women in Lok Sabha and State Assemblies (c) reservation for women in jobs (d) equal pay

Ans: (b).

18. 10% reservation for Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) was introduced by the:
(a) 101st (b) 102nd (c) 103rd (d) 104th Amendment

Ans: (c) 103rd Amendment, 2019.

19. The first meeting of the Constituent Assembly was held on:
(a) 26 Nov 1949 (b) 9 Dec 1946 (c) 15 Aug 1947 (d) 26 Jan 1946

Ans: (b) 9 December 1946. The temporary president was Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha.

20. A Money Bill is defined under:
(a) Art. 108 (b) Art. 110 (c) Art. 112 (d) Art. 117

Ans: (b) Article 110. (Art. 112 = Annual Financial Statement / Budget.)

21. Who decides whether a bill is a Money Bill?
(a) President (b) Finance Minister (c) Speaker of Lok Sabha (d) Chairman of Rajya Sabha

Ans: (c) The Speaker, and the decision is final.

22. The Comptroller and Auditor General is appointed under:
(a) Art. 76 (b) Art. 148 (c) Art. 165 (d) Art. 280

Ans: (b) Article 148. (Attorney General = Art. 76; Advocate General = Art. 165.)

§2 — NAGALAND & NORTH-EAST

23. The first general election to the Nagaland Legislative Assembly was held in:
(a) 1963 (b) 1964 (c) 1969 (d) 1972

Ans: (b) January 1964.

24. By population, the largest Naga tribe is generally cited as the:
(a) Ao (b) Angami (c) Konyak (d) Sumi

Ans: (c) Konyak.

25. Sükrünyi is the festival of the:
(a) Chakhesang (b) Rengma (c) Pochury (d) Zeliang

Ans: (a) Chakhesang (January).

26. Ngada is the festival of the:
(a) Rengma (b) Phom (c) Chang (d) Lotha

Ans: (a) Rengma (November).

27. Naknyulem is the festival of the:
(a) Konyak (b) Chang (c) Sangtam (d) Yimkhiung

Ans: (b) Chang (July).

28. Monyü is the festival of the:
(a) Phom (b) Konyak (c) Khamniungan (d) Ao

Ans: (a) Phom (April).

29. Hega is a festival of the:
(a) Zeliang (b) Kuki (c) Kachari (d) Garo

Ans: (a) Zeliang.

30. Tsokum is the festival of the:
(a) Sangtam (b) Khiamniungan (c) Yimkhiung (d) Pochury

Ans: (b) Khiamniungan (October).

31. The name "Kisama" (Naga Heritage Village) comes from the two villages:
(a) Kigwema and Phesama (b) Kiruphema and Sazolie (c) Kidima and Sechü (d) Khonoma and Jakhama

Ans: (a) Kigwema + Phesama.

32. Among Nagaland's wildlife sanctuaries, Fakim is in:
(a) Kohima (b) Kiphire (c) Mon (d) Dimapur

Ans: (b) Kiphire. (Puliebadze = Kohima; Rangapahar = Dimapur.)

33. Nagaland lies mostly in which physiographic region?
(a) Shillong Plateau (b) Patkai-Naga Hills (c) Mishmi Hills (d) Lushai Hills

Ans: (b) The Patkai range / Naga Hills.

34. Kohima Village (Bara Basti) is often described as:
(a) the smallest village in India (b) one of the largest villages in Asia (c) India's first smart village
(d) Nagaland's only Angami village

Ans: (b).

35. Manipur, Meghalaya and Tripura became full states on:
(a) 1 Dec 1963 (b) 21 Jan 1972 (c) 20 Feb 1987 (d) 16 May 1975

Ans: (b) 21 January 1972.

36. Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh became full states in:
(a) 1972 (b) 1975 (c) 1987 (d) 1963

Ans: (c) 1987 (20 February 1987).

37. Sikkim became a state of India in 1975 by the:
(a) 35th (b) 36th (c) 42nd (d) 13th Amendment

Ans: (b) 36th Amendment. It was the 22nd state.

38. Capital of Arunachal Pradesh:
(a) Tawang (b) Itanagar (c) Pasighat (d) Ziro

Ans: (b) Itanagar. Other NE capitals: Shillong, Aizawl, Agartala, Gangtok, Dispur, Imphal and Kohima.

39. The Siliguri Corridor ("Chicken's Neck") connects the North-East to the rest of India through:
(a) Bihar (b) West Bengal (c) Sikkim (d) Assam

Ans: (b) West Bengal.

40. Kaziranga National Park is famous for the:

- (a) Asiatic lion (b) one-horned rhinoceros (c) snow leopard (d) Sangai deer

Ans: (b) One-horned rhinoceros.

41. The Dholā-Sadiya Bridge (Bhupen Hazarika Setu) is on the river:

- (a) Brahmaputra (b) Lohit (c) Barak (d) Subansiri

Ans: (b) Lohit (Assam–Arunachal). Bogibeel is India's longest rail-cum-road bridge.

42. The Mizo Peace Accord was signed in:

- (a) 1975 (b) 1986 (c) 1987 (d) 1997

Ans: (b) 1986.

43. Living root bridges are a famous feature of:

- (a) Nagaland (b) Meghalaya (c) Sikkim (d) Tripura

Ans: (b) Meghalaya.

44. The Battle of Saraighat (1671), where the Ahoms defeated the Mughals, was led by:

- (a) Lachit Borphukan (b) Sukaphaa (c) Rudra Singha (d) Gadadhar Singha

Ans: (a) Lachit Borphukan. (Sukaphaa founded the Ahom kingdom in 1228.)

45. Losar, the New Year festival of the Monpas, is celebrated in:

- (a) Nagaland (b) Arunachal Pradesh (c) Mizoram (d) Manipur

Ans: (b) Arunachal Pradesh (and Sikkim/Ladakh). Chapchar Kut = Mizoram; Wangala = Garo, Meghalaya.

46. The Stilwell (Ledo) Road of WWII ran from Ledo in Assam to:

- (a) Mandalay (b) Kunming, China (c) Lhasa (d) Dhaka

Ans: (b) Kunming, China (via Burma).

§3 — INDIAN HISTORY

47. Harappa was first excavated in 1921 by:

- (a) R. D. Banerji (b) Daya Ram Sahni (c) John Marshall (d) Mortimer Wheeler

Ans: (b) Daya Ram Sahni. (Mohenjo-daro, 1922 → R. D. Banerji.)

48. The Harappan dockyard was found at:

- (a) Kalibangan (b) Lothal (c) Dholavira (d) Ropar

Ans: (b) Lothal (Gujarat).

49. The oldest Veda is the:

- (a) Samaveda (b) Yajurveda (c) Rigveda (d) Atharvaveda

Ans: (c) Rigveda.

50. Buddha delivered his first sermon at:

- (a) Bodh Gaya (b) Sarnath (c) Kushinagar (d) Lumbini

Ans: (b) Sarnath. (Born at Lumbini; enlightened at Bodh Gaya; died at Kushinagar.)

51. The 24th and last Tirthankara of Jainism was:

- (a) Rishabhanatha (b) Parshvanatha (c) Mahavira (d) Neminatha

Ans: (c) Mahavira.

52. Ashoka embraced Buddhism after the war of:

- (a) Magadha (b) Kalinga (c) Hydaspes (d) Taxila

Ans: (b) Kalinga (c. 261 BCE).

53. "Indica" was written by:

- (a) Fa-Hien (b) Megasthenes (c) Kautilya (d) Hiuen Tsang

Ans: (b) Megasthenes, Seleucus's envoy to Chandragupta Maurya. (Arthashastra → Kautilya.)

54. The Chinese pilgrim who visited India during Harshavardhana's reign was:

- (a) Fa-Hien (b) Hiuen Tsang (c) I-Tsing (d) Al-Biruni

Ans: (b) Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang).

55. The construction of the Qutb Minar was begun by:

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Qutb-ud-din Aibak (c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Balban

Ans: (b) Qutb-ud-din Aibak. It was completed by Iltutmish.

56. Din-i-Ilahi was started by:

- (a) Babur (b) Humayun (c) Akbar (d) Aurangzeb

Ans: (c) Akbar (1582).

57. The Battle of Plassey (1757) was fought between the British and:

- (a) Mir Qasim (b) Siraj-ud-Daulah (c) Tipu Sultan (d) Shuja-ud-Daulah

Ans: (b) Siraj-ud-Daulah. (Buxar, 1764 → Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daulah and Shah Alam II.)

58. The Permanent Settlement of Bengal (1793) was introduced by:

- (a) Warren Hastings (b) Lord Cornwallis (c) Lord Wellesley (d) Lord Dalhousie

Ans: (b) Lord Cornwallis.

59. The "Doctrine of Lapse" is associated with:

- (a) Lord Dalhousie (b) Lord Curzon (c) Lord Ripon (d) Lord Canning

Ans: (a) Lord Dalhousie.

60. Sati was abolished in 1829 by:

- (a) Lord William Bentinck (b) Lord Dalhousie (c) Lord Minto (d) Lord Lytton

Ans: (a) Lord William Bentinck, with the support of Raja Ram Mohan Roy.

61. The Revolt of 1857 began at:

- (a) Delhi (b) Kanpur (c) Meerut (d) Barrackpore

Ans: (c) Meerut (10 May 1857). (Mangal Pandey's act at Barrackpore was in March 1857.)

62. The Partition of Bengal (1905) was carried out by:
(a) Lord Minto (b) Lord Curzon (c) Lord Hardinge (d) Lord Ripon

Ans: (b) Lord Curzon. It was annulled in 1911.

63. Gandhiji's first satyagraha in India was at:
(a) Kheda (b) Ahmedabad (c) Champaran (d) Bardoli

Ans: (c) Champaran (1917), for indigo farmers.

64. The Non-Cooperation Movement was withdrawn after the incident at:
(a) Jallianwala Bagh (b) Chauri Chaura (c) Dandi (d) Bardoli

Ans: (b) Chauri Chaura (February 1922).

65. The "Purna Swaraj" resolution was passed at the Lahore session (1929), presided over by:
(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Jawaharlal Nehru (c) Motilal Nehru (d) Subhas Bose

Ans: (b) Jawaharlal Nehru. 26 January 1930 was observed as Independence Day.

66. The Poona Pact (1932) was signed between Gandhiji and:
(a) Jinnah (b) B. R. Ambedkar (c) Lord Irwin (d) Tej Bahadur Sapru

Ans: (b) Dr. B. R. Ambedkar.

67. "Give me blood, and I will give you freedom" was said by:
(a) Bhagat Singh (b) Subhas Chandra Bose (c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Lala Lajpat Rai

Ans: (b) Subhas Chandra Bose. ("Swaraj is my birthright" → Tilak.)

68. The first Indian Governor-General of independent India was:
(a) Lord Mountbatten (b) C. Rajagopalachari (c) Rajendra Prasad (d) Sardar Patel

Ans: (b) C. Rajagopalachari (the last Governor-General as well).

§4 — INDIAN ECONOMY

69. The Repo Rate is the rate at which:
(a) banks lend to the public (b) RBI lends short-term funds to commercial banks (c) banks park surplus with RBI (d) government borrows abroad

Ans: (b). Reverse repo is the rate RBI pays banks for parking funds.

70. The Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) is the share of deposits that banks must keep:
(a) as gold (b) with the RBI as cash (c) in government securities (d) as loans to farmers

Ans: (b) With the RBI, in cash. (SLR = liquid assets kept by the bank itself.)

71. The RBI's inflation target under flexible inflation targeting is:
(a) $2\% \pm 1\%$ (b) $4\% \pm 2\%$ (c) $5\% \pm 1\%$ (d) $6\% \pm 2\%$

Ans: (b) $4\% \pm 2\%$, measured by CPI.

72. Fiscal deficit means:
(a) total expenditure – revenue receipts (b) total expenditure – total receipts excluding borrowings
(c) imports – exports (d) revenue expenditure – revenue receipts

Ans: (b). Option (d) is the revenue deficit.

73. India's First Five-Year Plan (1951–56) was based on the:

(a) Mahalanobis model (b) Harrod-Domar model (c) Gadgil formula (d) Lewis model

Ans: (b) Harrod-Domar model. (The 2nd Plan used the Mahalanobis model.)

74. The "Father of the Green Revolution in India" is:

(a) Verghese Kurien (b) M. S. Swaminathan (c) Norman Borlaug (d) C. Subramaniam

Ans: (b) M. S. Swaminathan. (White/Operation Flood → Verghese Kurien.)

75. The "Blue Revolution" relates to:

(a) water conservation (b) fisheries (c) oilseeds (d) dairy

Ans: (b) Fisheries. (Yellow = oilseeds; Golden = horticulture/honey.)

76. How many banks were nationalised in 1969?

(a) 6 (b) 12 (c) 14 (d) 20

Ans: (c) 14 (followed by 6 more in 1980).

77. The economic reforms of 1991 (LPG) were introduced by Finance Minister:

(a) P. Chidambaram (b) Manmohan Singh (c) Yashwant Sinha (d) Pranab Mukherjee

Ans: (b) Dr. Manmohan Singh, under PM P. V. Narasimha Rao.

78. MGNREGA guarantees how many days of wage employment per rural household per year?

(a) 50 (b) 100 (c) 150 (d) 200

Ans: (b) 100 days. (The Act is from 2005.)

79. UPI was developed by:

(a) RBI (b) SBI (c) NPCI (d) SEBI

Ans: (c) National Payments Corporation of India (launched 2016).

80. Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY provides health cover per family per year of up to:

(a) ₹1 lakh (b) ₹2 lakh (c) ₹5 lakh (d) ₹10 lakh

Ans: (c) ₹5 lakh.

81. Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (financial inclusion) was launched in:

(a) 2012 (b) 2014 (c) 2016 (d) 2018

Ans: (b) August 2014.

82. Headquarters of the World Trade Organization:

(a) Washington DC (b) New York (c) Geneva (d) Paris

Ans: (c) Geneva. (IMF & World Bank → Washington DC; ADB → Manila; NDB (BRICS) → Shanghai.)

83. Demonetisation of ₹500 and ₹1000 notes was announced on:

(a) 8 Nov 2016 (b) 1 July 2017 (c) 31 Dec 2016 (d) 8 Nov 2015

Ans: (a) 8 November 2016.

84. SEBI became a statutory body in:

- (a) 1988 (b) 1992 (c) 1995 (d) 2000

Ans: (b) 1992. It was set up in 1988.

§5 — GEOGRAPHY (India & World)

85. Indian Standard Time is based on the 82°30'E meridian, which passes near:

- (a) Delhi (b) Mirzapur (c) Nagpur (d) Kolkata

Ans: (b) Mirzapur (UP). IST = GMT + 5:30.

86. The largest Indian state by area is:

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Maharashtra (c) Rajasthan (d) Uttar Pradesh

Ans: (c) Rajasthan. Goa is the smallest.

87. Which rivers flow westward into the Arabian Sea through rift valleys?

- (a) Godavari & Krishna (b) Narmada & Tapi (c) Mahanadi & Kaveri (d) Ganga & Yamuna

Ans: (b) Narmada & Tapi.

88. The longest peninsular river, called "Dakshin Ganga", is the:

- (a) Krishna (b) Kaveri (c) Godavari (d) Mahanadi

Ans: (c) Godavari.

89. India's largest freshwater lake is:

- (a) Chilika (b) Wular (c) Dal (d) Loktak

Ans: (b) Wular (J&K). Chilika is the largest brackish-water lagoon; Sambhar the largest inland salt lake; **Loktak** the largest freshwater lake in NE India.

90. The Brahmaputra enters India in Arunachal Pradesh, where it is called the:

- (a) Tsangpo (b) Siang / Dihang (c) Lohit (d) Subansiri

Ans: (b) Siang / Dihang. It is called the Tsangpo in Tibet and the Jamuna in Bangladesh.

91. Black (regur) soil is best suited for:

- (a) Tea (b) Cotton (c) Rice (d) Coffee

Ans: (b) Cotton.

92. The wettest place on earth (highest average rainfall) is:

- (a) Cherrapunji (b) Mawsynram (c) Agumbe (d) Tawang

Ans: (b) Mawsynram (Meghalaya).

93. The Palk Strait separates India from:

- (a) Maldives (b) Sri Lanka (c) Myanmar (d) Indonesia

Ans: (b) Sri Lanka.

94. The Ten Degree Channel separates:

- (a) India & Sri Lanka (b) Andaman & Nicobar Islands (c) Lakshadweep & Maldives (d) North & Middle Andaman

Ans: (b) Andaman from Nicobar.

95. India's southernmost point is:

(a) Kanyakumari (b) Indira Point (c) Rameswaram (d) Minicoy

Ans: (b) Indira Point (Great Nicobar). Kanyakumari is the southern tip of the mainland.

96. Lakshadweep islands are of ____ origin.

(a) volcanic (b) coral (c) continental (d) glacial

Ans: (b) Coral.

97. The south-west monsoon normally reaches Kerala around:

(a) 1 May (b) 1 June (c) 1 July (d) 15 August

Ans: (b) 1 June.

98. The largest ocean is the:

(a) Atlantic (b) Indian (c) Pacific (d) Arctic

Ans: (c) Pacific.

99. The longest river in the world is generally cited as the:

(a) Amazon (b) Nile (c) Yangtze (d) Mississippi

Ans: (b) Nile.

100. The height of Mount Everest (China–Nepal survey, 2020) is:

(a) 8,848 m (b) 8,849 m (c) 8,611 m (d) 8,586 m

Ans: (b) 8,848.86 m $\approx$ 8,849 m.

101. The largest tea-producing state in India is:

(a) West Bengal (b) Kerala (c) Assam (d) Tamil Nadu

Ans: (c) Assam.

102. The Tropic of Cancer passes through how many Indian states?

(a) 6 (b) 7 (c) 8 (d) 9

Ans: (c) 8.

§6 — GENERAL SCIENCE

103. The SI unit of force is the:

(a) Joule (b) Newton (c) Watt (d) Pascal

Ans: (b) Newton. (Energy $\rightarrow$ joule; power $\rightarrow$ watt; pressure $\rightarrow$ pascal; resistance $\rightarrow$ ohm.)

104. The speed of light in vacuum is about:

(a) 3×10^5 m/s (b) 3×10^8 m/s (c) 3×10^6 km/s (d) 330 m/s

Ans: (b) 3×10^8 m/s. (Sound in air $\approx$ 340 m/s.)

105. Sound cannot travel through:

(a) water (b) steel (c) vacuum (d) air

Ans: (c) Vacuum. Sound travels fastest in solids.

106. The sky appears blue because of:

(a) reflection (b) refraction (c) scattering of light (d) dispersion

Ans: (c) (Rayleigh) scattering. A rainbow is due to dispersion (with refraction and internal reflection).

107. Short-sightedness (myopia) is corrected by a:

(a) convex lens (b) concave lens (c) bifocal lens (d) cylindrical lens

Ans: (b) Concave lens. (Hypermetropia → convex.)

108. The hardest natural substance is:

(a) Iron (b) Quartz (c) Diamond (d) Graphite

Ans: (c) Diamond.

109. The most abundant gas in Earth's atmosphere is:

(a) Oxygen (b) Nitrogen (c) Carbon dioxide (d) Argon

Ans: (b) Nitrogen (~78%). Oxygen is ~21%.

110. "Laughing gas" is:

(a) CO (b) N₂O (c) NO₂ (d) NH₃

Ans: (b) Nitrous oxide, N₂O.

111. The pH of pure water at 25 °C is:

(a) 0 (b) 5 (c) 7 (d) 14

Ans: (c) 7. Human blood is ≈ 7.4 (slightly alkaline).

112. Galvanisation is coating iron with:

(a) Tin (b) Zinc (c) Copper (d) Chromium

Ans: (b) Zinc.

113. Chlorophyll contains the metal:

(a) Iron (b) Magnesium (c) Copper (d) Calcium

Ans: (b) Magnesium. Haemoglobin contains iron.

114. Insulin is secreted by the:

(a) Liver (b) Pancreas (c) Thyroid (d) Adrenal gland

Ans: (b) Pancreas (Islets of Langerhans). A deficiency causes diabetes.

115. The largest gland in the human body is the:

(a) Pancreas (b) Liver (c) Thyroid (d) Pituitary

Ans: (b) Liver. The largest organ is the skin; the smallest bone is the stapes (ear).

116. Normal human body temperature is:

(a) 35 °C (b) 37 °C (c) 39 °C (d) 98.6 °C

Ans: (b) 37 °C (= 98.6 °F).

117. The average lifespan of human red blood cells is about:

- (a) 30 days (b) 60 days (c) 120 days (d) 1 year

Ans: (c) 120 days.

118. Penicillin was discovered by:

- (a) Louis Pasteur (b) Alexander Fleming (c) Edward Jenner (d) Robert Koch

Ans: (b) Alexander Fleming (1928). (Smallpox vaccine → Jenner.)

119. The double-helix structure of DNA was proposed by:

- (a) Mendel (b) Watson & Crick (c) Darwin (d) Landsteiner

Ans: (b) Watson & Crick (1953). (Blood groups → Landsteiner.)

120. Malaria is caused by:

- (a) a virus (b) a bacterium (c) *Plasmodium*, a protozoan (d) a fungus

Ans: (c) Plasmodium. It spreads through the female *Anopheles* mosquito. (Dengue → *Aedes* mosquito, virus.)

121. The ozone layer, which absorbs UV radiation, lies in the:

- (a) Troposphere (b) Stratosphere (c) Mesosphere (d) Thermosphere

Ans: (b) Stratosphere.

122. At what temperature are the Celsius and Fahrenheit readings equal?

- (a) 0° (b) -40° (c) 100° (d) -273°

Ans: (b) -40°.

123. ISRO was established in:

- (a) 1962 (b) 1969 (c) 1972 (d) 1975

Ans: (b) 1969 (HQ Bengaluru). India's first satellite was **Aryabhata** (1975).

124. Chandrayaan-3 landed near the Moon's south pole on:

- (a) 14 July 2023 (b) 23 August 2023 (c) 2 September 2023 (d) 22 July 2019

Ans: (b) 23 August 2023. The landing site is "Shiv Shakti Point", and 23 August is now National Space Day.

§7 — COMPUTERS & TECHNOLOGY

125. The "Father of the Computer" is:

- (a) Alan Turing (b) Charles Babbage (c) John von Neumann (d) Tim Berners-Lee

Ans: (b) Charles Babbage.

126. The World Wide Web was invented by:

- (a) Vint Cerf (b) Tim Berners-Lee (c) Bill Gates (d) Steve Jobs

Ans: (b) Tim Berners-Lee (1989, CERN). (TCP/IP → Vint Cerf & Bob Kahn.)

127. 1 byte =

- (a) 4 bits (b) 8 bits (c) 16 bits (d) 1024 bits

Ans: (b) 8 bits. 1 KB = 1024 bytes.

128. Which memory is volatile?

(a) ROM (b) Hard disk (c) RAM (d) Flash drive

Ans: (c) RAM. Its contents are lost when power goes off.

129. HTTP stands for:

(a) HyperText Transfer Protocol (b) High Transfer Text Protocol (c) HyperText Transmission Program (d) Hyperlink Text Transfer Process

Ans: (a).

130. A fraudulent email that tricks users into revealing passwords is called:

(a) Spam (b) Phishing (c) Firewall (d) Cookie

Ans: (b) Phishing.

131. India's first supercomputer, PARAM 8000 (1991), was built by:

(a) ISRO (b) C-DAC (c) BARC (d) DRDO

Ans: (b) C-DAC, Pune.

132. The keyboard shortcut to undo the last action (Windows) is:

(a) Ctrl + Y (b) Ctrl + Z (c) Ctrl + U (d) Ctrl + X

Ans: (b) Ctrl + Z. (Ctrl + Y = redo; Ctrl + X = cut.)

§8 — MENTAL ABILITY

133. Next term: 1, 4, 9, 16, 25, ?

(a) 30 (b) 35 (c) 36 (d) 49

Ans: (c) 36. These are the squares.

134. Next term: 5, 11, 23, 47, ?

(a) 94 (b) 95 (c) 96 (d) 71

Ans: (b) 95. The rule is $\times 2 + 1$.

135. Simple interest on ₹5,000 at 8% per annum for 3 years:

(a) ₹1,000 (b) ₹1,200 (c) ₹1,400 (d) ₹1,500

Ans: (b) ₹1,200. $SI = \frac{PRT}{100} = \frac{5000 \times 8 \times 3}{100}$.

136. An article bought for ₹400 is sold for ₹500. Profit % =

(a) 20% (b) 25% (c) 30% (d) 100%

Ans: (b) 25%. $\frac{100}{400} \times 100$.

137. If the price of rice rises by 25%, by how much must consumption fall to keep spending unchanged?

(a) 25% (b) 20% (c) 15% (d) 30%

Ans: (b) 20%. $\frac{25}{125} \times 100$.

138. 15% of 240 =
(a) 24 (b) 30 (c) 36 (d) 40

Ans: (c) 36.

139. How many times in a day are the hands of a clock at right angles?
(a) 22 (b) 24 (c) 44 (d) 48

Ans: (c) 44. (They coincide 22 times and point opposite 22 times.)

140. If CAT = 24 (sum of letter positions), DOG = ?
(a) 24 (b) 25 (c) 26 (d) 27

Ans: (c) 26. D(4) + O(15) + G(7).

141. Doctor : Hospital :: Teacher : ?
(a) Student (b) Book (c) School (d) Class

Ans: (c) School. It is the place of work.

142. Which of these is a leap year?
(a) 1900 (b) 2100 (c) 2000 (d) 1800

Ans: (c) 2000. A century year is a leap year only if divisible by 400.

§9 — GENERAL ENGLISH

143. Synonym of **BENEVOLENT**:
(a) Cruel (b) Kind (c) Greedy (d) Timid

Ans: (b) Kind.

144. Synonym of **OBSOLETE**:
(a) Modern (b) Outdated (c) Rare (d) Useful

Ans: (b) Outdated.

145. Synonym of **METICULOUS**:
(a) Careless (b) Very careful and precise (c) Hasty (d) Generous

Ans: (b).

146. Antonym of **HUMBLE**:
(a) Modest (b) Arrogant (c) Meek (d) Polite

Ans: (b) Arrogant.

147. Antonym of **OPTIMIST**:
(a) Realist (b) Pessimist (c) Idealist (d) Activist

Ans: (b) Pessimist.

148. Idiom — "**to break the ice**":
(a) to start a quarrel (b) to begin a conversation in an awkward situation (c) to fall through a frozen lake (d) to break a rule

Ans: (b).

149. Idiom — "**at the eleventh hour**":

(a) late at night (b) at the last possible moment (c) too early (d) on time

Ans: (b).

150. Idiom — "**to cry over spilt milk**":

(a) to regret what cannot be undone (b) to waste food (c) to complain about prices (d) to be a crybaby

Ans: (a).

151. One word: *Fear of heights*:

(a) Claustrophobia (b) Hydrophobia (c) Acrophobia (d) Xenophobia

Ans: (c) Acrophobia. (Claustro- = closed spaces; hydro- = water; xeno- = foreigners.)

152. One word: *Killing of a king*:

(a) Homicide (b) Regicide (c) Patricide (d) Genocide

Ans: (b) Regicide.

153. One word: *A place where birds are kept*:

(a) Apiary (b) Aviary (c) Aquarium (d) Kennel

Ans: (b) Aviary. (Apiary = bees.)

154. One word: *One who loves mankind*:

(a) Misanthrope (b) Philanthropist (c) Philatelist (d) Misogynist

Ans: (b) Philanthropist. (Philatelist = stamp collector.)

155. Spot the error: "I **am knowing** him / for many years."

(a) I am knowing him (b) for many years (c) No error

Ans: (a) → "I **have known** him for many years." *Know* is a stative verb; with *for* + a period, use the present perfect.

156. Fill in the blank: "No sooner had he arrived ____ it started raining."

(a) when (b) than (c) then (d) as

Ans: (b) than. (But: *Hardly/Scarcely ... when.*)

157. Fill in the blank: "He was angry ____ me for coming late."

(a) at (b) on (c) with (d) upon

Ans: (c) with. Angry **with** a person, angry **at** a thing.

158. Fill in the article: "____ Brahmaputra flows through Assam."

(a) A (b) An (c) The (d) No article

Ans: (c) The. Rivers, oceans and mountain ranges take *the*.

159. Plural of **mother-in-law**:

(a) mother-in-laws (b) mothers-in-law (c) mothers-in-laws (d) mother-ins-law

Ans: (b) mothers-in-law.

160. Choose the correctly spelt word:

(a) Occurence (b) Occurrence (c) Ocurrence (d) Occurance

Ans: (b) Occurrence (double c, double r, -ence).

Section tracker

§	Section	Qs	Score
1	Polity	22	—
2	Nagaland & NE	24	—
3	History	22	—
4	Economy	16	—
5	Geography	18	—
6	Science	22	—
7	Computers	8	—
8	Mental Ability	10	—
9	English	18	—
	Total	160	—